

- All the speakers should point at where you're sitting. But there's a difference of opinion as to how far they should be from you. Most agree that the front and centre speakers should be at the same distance from you. But while some say that the rear speakers should also be at the same distance, some say they should be a bit further away. Experiment!
- Place the front speakers in an equilateral triangle with your seat, and closer to your seat than the TV or monitor is. Angle them inwards by about 30 degrees so that most of the sound seems to be coming from the monitor or TV.
- Place the centre speaker on the monitor or TV, or somewhere in the TV cabinet, hopefully at ear level.
- The subwoofer can be placed anywhere convenient, but it's generally considered better to place it near the front. But experiment with it such that you can't make out where it is when music is playing. For better bass, place it somewhat close to a wall.
- Place the rear speakers behind and to the sides of the viewing seat. The spacing between them should be about double the spacing between the front speakers. Since they're so far apart, the principle we stated in the case of 2.1 speakers holds—angle them towards each other.

1.7 Setting Up A Home Theatre PC

If you're about to buy a PC now, think about a home theatre—your PC doesn't have to be stuffed away in your bedroom; you can bring it out into the living room and, coupled with a DLP projector and great 5.1 speakers, turn it into a complete home theatre solution. Here's what you'll need.

Processor, motherboard, power supply: For the processor, we'd recommend an AMD 939-pin Athlon64 3800+ or a dual-core Athlon X2 4400+. For the motherboard, consider the PCIe Asus A8N-VM CSM. It's based on the NVIDIA GeForce 6150 + nForce 430, has support for dual-channel DDR400 RAM, an integrated GeForce6 GPU, dual VGA output—DVI-D and RGB, NVIDIA Gigabit LAN with